

Hospitality Perspectives

Publication 03

The Professional Behind the Perspective

A Short Executive Biography

Author

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Prepared under the Walton Hospitality Consulting Professional Development Initiative

Executive Reflection

Every hospitality professional develops a different way of looking at the industry.

Mine has been shaped by working across luxury hotels, destination resorts and commercial operations in Europe, North America, Australia and the United Kingdom.

Rather than viewing hospitality as individual departments or isolated commercial functions, I have gradually come to see it as one connected system where operational decisions, commercial strategy and guest experience continually influence one another.

That perspective continues to guide both my professional work and my interest in hospitality advisory.

Professional Journey

My interest in destination hospitality began during my first contract in Australia, where I became fascinated by how the different parts of a resort worked together to create a successful guest experience.

That curiosity continued throughout my career as I worked across luxury hotels, destination resorts, revenue support, sales, guest operations and commercial environments in several international markets.

Over time, I found myself becoming less interested in individual departments and increasingly interested in understanding how commercial decisions influence the wider hospitality ecosystem.

My Master's degree in Tourism Management later provided the academic framework for ideas that had already been developing through practical experience, particularly around destination sustainability and long-term commercial performance.

Professional Focus Today

Today my professional interests centre on hospitality commercial performance, customer success, destination strategy and hospitality advisory.

I enjoy understanding how organisations work, how commercial processes influence operational performance and how thoughtful questioning can help leaders make better-informed decisions.

Rather than viewing technology as a replacement for professional judgement, I see it as a powerful tool that enables better conversations, stronger commercial understanding and more confident decision-making.

Professional Reflection

Throughout my career I have become increasingly convinced that hospitality performs best when commercial decisions are viewed within the wider context of people, operations and destination value.

Reports provide evidence.

Experience provides context.

Professional judgement helps connect the two.

That combination continues to shape both my work and the perspectives shared throughout this publication series.

About the Author

Mladen Janev is a hospitality commercial professional with more than 20 years of international experience across luxury hotels, destination resorts and customer-facing commercial operations in Europe, North America, Australia and the United Kingdom.

His work has focused on commercial performance, destination ecosystems and the relationship between operational decisions, guest experience and long-term asset value.

He has a particular interest in hospitality technology, customer success and advisory, where commercial intelligence, operational understanding and practical judgement come together to help organisations make better long-term decisions.

Mladen holds a Master's degree in Tourism Management and a Cornell University Revenue Management Certificate, and continues to develop professional case studies exploring commercial strategy within the hospitality industry through the Hospitality Perspectives publication series.

About Hospitality Perspectives

Hospitality Perspectives is an independent publication series exploring practical observations from hotels, destination resorts, hospitality technology and commercial operations. Each publication is written to encourage thoughtful discussion among hospitality leaders and support better-informed commercial decision-making.

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